

MAHMUD ABDUL GAFAR

Software Engineer · Co-Founder, Ketapay

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Versatile Software Engineer and co-founder of Ketapay, an escrow platform securing payments for Nigerian businesses that buy and sell online. I build responsive, user-centered web and mobile products across the stack — from React and TypeScript front-ends to Java/Spring Boot services — and I move fluently between writing code, reading and reasoning about unfamiliar codebases, and shaping raw ideas into clear, buildable solutions. Originally trained in the sciences, I transitioned into software engineering in 2023 and have since taken on full product ownership, hands-on QA, and engineering leadership. I'm known as a fast learner and a dependable problem solver who ships reliable software in collaborative teams.

CORE STRENGTHS

- **Full-stack engineering** — React, TypeScript, JavaScript, Java/Spring Boot, Node.js, PHP, with component-based architecture and clean API integration.
- **Code fluency** — reads and reasons about unfamiliar codebases quickly to debug, refactor, and extend existing systems with confidence.
- **Problem framing & solution design** — strong at outlining ideas, breaking down ambiguous problems, and turning them into structured, shippable plans.
- **Quality & user experience** — hands-on QA across UI flows, system flows, and end-to-end user journeys for web and mobile.
- **Product ownership** — takes features from concept and MVP through to deployment, support, and iteration.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Co-Founder & Software Engineer 2023 – Present

Ketapay — Escrow Platform for Nigerian Buyers & Sellers

- Co-founded Ketapay, an escrow platform that protects online transactions between Nigerian businesses by holding buyer funds securely until both parties confirm a completed sale.
- Began as QA Engineer, owning testing of the mobile app's UI flows, end-to-end system flows, and user experience — defining test cases, catching defects before release, and raising the product's overall reliability.
- Grew into a core engineering and product role, contributing to architecture decisions, feature design, and the technical direction of the platform as a founder.
- Drove the product vision, translating business requirements for secure escrow payments into clear, prioritized engineering work and intuitive user journeys.
- Collaborated across design, engineering, and operations to ship a trustworthy payments experience tailored to the realities of Nigerian commerce.

Backend Engineer — Authentication & Security Module March 2024

Fintech Escrow Platform (Java / Spring Boot)

- Designed and built a scalable authentication and password-validation module for a fintech escrow platform, meeting enterprise-grade security requirements for financial transactions.
- Engineered a custom validation engine using Java Regex, Jakarta Bean Validation, and Spring Security to enforce strict password policies aligned with financial-industry standards.
- Built secure RESTful endpoints for authentication and credential validation, integrating JWT for stateless session management and verified user identity.
- Applied BCrypt hashing via Spring Security so credentials were never stored in plain text, and delivered the module as a reusable, dependency-injected Spring component for the platform's microservices.

Full-Stack Engineer — Food Delivery App (MVP) Aug 2023 – Nov 2025

End-to-End Product Build (React · TypeScript · Node.js)

- Designed and developed a full-stack food delivery web application, owning the product end-to-end from architecture to deployment.
- Built dynamic cart functionality with custom React Hooks (e.g. useCart) for item selection, persistence, and session continuity, improving the checkout experience.

- Integrated APIs and optimized data flow between front-end and back-end, achieving faster response times and smoother checkout.
- Delivered a scalable MVP that demonstrated full product ownership, technical flexibility, and the ability to turn an idea into a working solution.

Front-End Engineer — Scalable TypeScript Refactor (MVP) 2023

OneStop Solutions

- Refactored a critical production module to TypeScript, enforcing strong type safety, eliminating runtime type errors, and reducing debugging time.
- Designed a modular, reusable architecture that could be integrated across multiple applications, improving development efficiency and code consistency.
- Transformed legacy JavaScript into type-driven, component-based structures, improving maintainability and enabling faster feature delivery.
- Established standardized, self-documenting code patterns that improved developer onboarding and set a foundation for future growth.

Web Developer — Construction Company Website Sep 2023 – Dec 2025

Nalot Multisystems Limited

- Developed and deployed a responsive website for a construction company using WordPress and PHP, improving online visibility across devices.
- Customized themes, plugins, and PHP to deliver service listings, contact forms, project showcases, and dynamic pages (blog, portfolio, testimonials) that drove client engagement.
- Optimized performance and SEO, improving page-load speed and search rankings, and implemented validated, spam-protected contact forms to boost lead generation.
- Managed hosting, domain, backups, and SSL, ensuring uptime and a secure user experience, with ongoing post-launch support and feature updates.

Software Developer — Office Management App Apr 2022 – Jun 2023

Nalot Multisystems Limited, Abuja

- Contributed to building an office-operations platform, including an attendance clock-in system.
- Implemented staff authentication with role-based access to internal data, letting users view, manage, and update their profiles.
- Organized and structured company data to support efficient, streamlined operations aligned with project requirements.

ICT Support & Digital Learning Facilitator Apr 2021 – Apr 2024

Digital Economy Learning Centre — NITDA, Nigeria

- Deployed and maintained connectivity for learning centres nationwide (KU-band, 3 Mbps down / 2 Mbps up).
- Installed e-learning infrastructure, hosting SaaS learning material on local servers networked to every system, plus computers and HUAWEI IdeaHub units across centres.
- Delivered hands-on digital tutorial classes to learners across the country.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, Java, PHP, HTML, CSS

Frameworks & Libraries: React, React Hooks, Node.js, Spring Boot, Tailwind CSS, WordPress

Practices & Tools: Component-based architecture, state management, REST API integration, JWT & Spring Security, QA / UI & system-flow testing, debugging & refactoring, Postman, Git/GitHub, Office 365

Strengths: Reading & reasoning about code, idea outlining, problem solving, product ownership, fast learning

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

B.Sc. Zoology — Kwara State University 2015 – 2019

CS50: Introduction to Computer Science — HarvardX (edX) 2025 – Present

- Foundational coursework in algorithms, data structures, SQL, HTML/CSS, and web development principles. Part of a deliberate transition into software engineering begun in 2023.

INTERESTS

Football · Basketball · Board Games · Sky Diving